

Pay stubs (your employer sends a W-2 at the end of the year)

Save for seven years:

Bank statements, credit card statements, receipts, and any documents you've saved for tax deduction purposes (which you may need to produce if you're audited by the Internal Revenue Service)

Save forever:

Birth certificate

College transcripts

Credit card agreement (for as long as you have the card)

Diplomas

Divorce decree and property agreement

Home improvement receipts (if you own your home; see Chapter 9 for details)

Home inventory (you'll learn about this in Chapter 8)

Insurance policies

Loan agreements

Marriage certificate

Passport (current one)

Pension plan and retirement plan documents

Receipts for major purchases (to use as proof in case of a fire or burglary)

Social Security card

Stock purchase agreements

Tax returns and additional tax forms

Warranties (for as long as they last)

Work performance reviews, memos on job performance

Year-end pay stubs and bonus statements